IOWN

The Morning Brief

APRIL 17, 2026

Summit Day

The S&P extends to its third consecutive all-time high as 40 nations convene on Hormuz reopening, Israel-Lebanon reach a ceasefire, and AMD's 12-day streak becomes the longest in two decades.

S&P 500	BRENT CRUDE	GOLD	BITCOIN	FEAR & GREED
7,017+ · 3rd ATH	~$99 ↑3.7%	~$4,830 · Flat	~$74,500 · Flat	21 · Improving

SECTION 01

Markets

THIRD CONSECUTIVE ALL-TIME HIGH — THE TAPE IS CONSOLIDATING AT RECORD LEVELS

Thursday extended the streak: SPY closed at $701.66 (+0.25%) with an intraday high of $702.78, marking the third consecutive session at an all-time high. The Dow gained 0.19%, the Nasdaq added 0.48%, and the Russell 2000 rose 0.21%. UVXY was essentially flat at −0.26%, reflecting a market that has shifted from repricing risk to absorbing it. The session's breadth was mixed: energy (+1.47%) led on an oil rebound, followed by communications services (+1.25%) and tech (+1.14%). Healthcare (−0.79%), industrials (−0.50%), and discretionary (−0.47%) lagged. Financials slipped 0.27% as bank earnings momentum paused following the strong JPM, Citi, BAC, and MS results earlier in the week. S&P futures are up approximately 0.11–0.18% in Friday premarket, hovering near 7,094. Goldman data shows hedge fund stock buying reached $86 billion this week on Iran peace hopes—the institutional bid is arriving.

AMD +7.80% — 12-DAY WINNING STREAK, THE LONGEST IN TWO DECADES

AMD surged 7.80% to $278.26 on Thursday, extending its winning streak to 12 consecutive sessions—the longest in over twenty years, according to Invezz. The catalyst was twofold: TSMC's Q1 results confirmed that AI-driven chip demand remains robust, and Bernstein raised AMD's price target to $265 from $235, citing the company's expanding footprint in higher-margin server and data center chips through its Meta partnership. AMD has gained approximately 42% from its late-March low during the war's most intense phase. The stock represents IOWN's thesis at work: physical AI infrastructure demand that persists through geopolitical disruption. MARA also surged 10.32%, and FTNT recovered 3.47% from the zero-day vulnerability selloff. On the other side, TSM gave back 3.13% on profit-taking despite the strong Q1, and LRCX slipped 1.58%.

ABT −6.00% — NARROW EARNINGS MISS, EXACT SCIENCES ACQUISITION CLOUDS THE READ

Abbott Laboratories, reporting its Q1 results on Thursday, posted adjusted EPS of $1.15 versus the $1.16 consensus—a one-penny miss. Revenue of $11.2 billion exceeded expectations by approximately $160 million, representing 8% year-over-year growth. The Exact Sciences acquisition, which closed March 23, contributed approximately $3 billion in incremental annualized sales, with Cancer Diagnostics including Cologuard growing at mid-teens rates. Despite the revenue beat, the market sold ABT 6.00% to $95.47, making it IOWN's second-worst performer on the day. The reaction

suggests investors are skeptical of the Exact Sciences integration timeline or concerned about margin dilution. For the dividend sleeve, ABT remains a core cash-generative holding; the Q1 miss was narrow and the revenue trajectory is intact, but near-term price action may require patience.

OIL REBOUNDS AS THE STRAIT REMAINS EFFECTIVELY CLOSED

Brent crude rose 3.72% and WTI gained 2.65% on Thursday, partially reversing the multi-session retreat. The catalyst: despite the ceasefire framework and renewed negotiations, the Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed, with Iran limiting transit and charging tolls exceeding $1 million per ship. The structural supply deficit has not been resolved by the ceasefire; it has merely been paused diplomatically. IOWN's energy sleeve responded: VLO gained 2.87% and CNX added 1.04%. The energy trade is no longer providing the one-directional ballast of the war's early weeks, but it retains relevance as a structural hedge against Hormuz normalization delays. Gold was flat (−0.09%) and is set for its fourth weekly gain, according to Reuters.

SPY	$701.66 · ↑0.25% · 3rd consecutive ATH
AMD	$278.26 · ↑7.80% · 12-day streak
ABT	$95.47 · ↓6.00% · Q1 $1.15 vs $1.16 est
BRENT CRUDE	~$99 · ↑3.72% · Hormuz still closed
HEDGE FUND FLOWS	$86B in stock buying this week (Goldman)
FEAR & GREED	21 · Institutional positioning catching up

Three consecutive all-time highs. Hedge funds buying $86 billion in a single week. AMD on its longest streak in twenty years. The market is not just recovering from the war—it is repricing for a post-conflict world where AI infrastructure demand, strong bank earnings, and regulatory reform (the SEC day-trading rule) are the operative catalysts. The discipline now is the same as during the drawdown: own the thesis, not the noise. **Research Reveals Opportunities.**

Geopolitics

40-NATION HORMUZ SUMMIT CONVENES TODAY — WITHOUT THE US OR ISRAEL

French President Macron and UK Prime Minister Starmer are co-chairing a virtual summit today of approximately 40 nations focused on how to ensure security of commercial shipping through the Strait of Hormuz once the Iran war ends, according to NBC News and CBS News. The US and Israel are notably absent from the summit's participant list, reflecting the diplomatic fracture that emerged when the UK declined to join the US Navy blockade. The objective is to create a "defensive multilateral mission" framework for Hormuz security that operates independently of the US blockade. If the summit produces a credible multinational naval framework, it could accelerate Hormuz normalization by providing Iran with an alternative security architecture to the bilateral US demands. For energy markets, a multilateral approach may be more durable than a US-only blockade and could reduce the geopolitical risk premium embedded in oil prices over time.

ISRAEL-LEBANON CEASEFIRE REACHED — ONE FRONT CLOSES AS HORMUZ REMAINS GRIDLOCKED

Israel and Lebanon reached a ceasefire agreement, according to CBS News and NBC News, closing one of the multiple fronts that had complicated any comprehensive peace framework. The Lebanon front, where more than 1,300 people were killed since Israeli attacks escalated in early March, had been a persistent obstacle to broader negotiations because Iran linked the Lebanon operations to any ceasefire terms. With this front resolved, the remaining issues narrow to the nuclear question, Hormuz transit rights, and reparations—still formidable but incrementally more manageable. Trump stated the US is "very close" to a deal with Iran, and the ceasefire's April 21 expiration remains four days away. If the framework extends, the equity market likely consolidates at these levels; if it lapses, the first real test of the new all-time highs arrives.

HORMUZ SUMMIT	Today · 40 nations · UK/France co-chair · No US/Israel
ISRAEL-LEBANON	Ceasefire reached · One front closes
TRUMP ON IRAN	"Very close" to a deal
CEASEFIRE EXPIRY	~April 21 · 4 days remaining
HORMUZ STATUS	Effectively closed · Tolls exceed $1M/ship

SECTION 03

On Our Radar

1. The Hormuz summit's outcome could reshape the oil premium this weekend. If the 40-nation framework produces a concrete plan for multilateral naval security in the Strait, oil could retreat further and the equity rally has room to extend. If the summit is purely aspirational, the Strait remains Iran's leverage and the April 21 deadline retains its significance. The energy sleeve (CVX, VLO, OKE) is the portfolio's direct proxy for the summit's outcome. *Think Like an Owner.*

2. AMD's 12-day streak validates the semiconductor thesis through the entire conflict cycle. From the war's onset through the TurboQuant scare, the SMIC sanctions risk, and the blockade, AMD has recovered from sub-$200 to $278. The AI infrastructure demand thesis—CPU pricing power, TSMC capacity constraints, Meta partnership—has proven resilient to every geopolitical overlay. IOWN's semi sleeve (AMD, NVDA, TSM, LRCX, KEYS, ADI, NXPI) remains the portfolio's cleanest secular growth exposure. **The physical world matters.**

3. ABT's reaction to a one-penny miss is a signal about the market's tolerance at ATH. At new highs, the bar for earnings beats rises and misses get punished disproportionately. ABT's 6% decline on $0.01 below consensus illustrates this dynamic. With Q1 reporting season accelerating, IOWN holdings that miss—even narrowly—may face outsized reactions. The dividend sleeve's cash-generative names (ADP, FAST, SYK, DGX) are the most exposed to this risk in the coming weeks. *Avoid Erosion.*

4. Hedge fund flows at $86 billion signal institutional catch-up. Goldman data shows the largest weekly institutional equity buying in months, driven by Iran peace hopes. Extreme Fear at 21—still well below neutral—suggests further room for positioning normalization. If hedge fund buying continues into next week, the bid at these levels becomes self-reinforcing. *Simplicity Over Complexity.*

5. Week ahead: ceasefire expiration, ABT fallout, and earnings season deepens. The April 21 ceasefire deadline is Monday. IOWN earnings on deck in coming weeks include GPC (April 21), TEL (April 22), SYK (late April). The Warsh Fed Chair confirmation hearing remains delayed. If the weekend produces a ceasefire extension, Monday opens with reduced geopolitical risk at all-time-high levels—historically a constructive setup for follow-through buying. *Research Reveals Opportunities.*

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